

Parent Guide — primary / module-13- indic-ecology

IKS Curriculum

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Parent Guide — Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary)

What is your child learning?

Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam — “the world is one family” — from the Mahā Upaniṣad (6.71–73) anchors the Indian ecological tradition. Combined with the Pṛthivī Sūkta (Atharva Veda 12.1), Iṣopaniṣad mantra 1, and Bhagavad Gītā 3.10–14 on *yajña* as ecological cycle, students encounter classical frameworks and apply them to modern climate and sustainability challenges.

Why this matters

This module is part of an Indian Knowledge Systems curriculum that introduces classical Indian frameworks alongside their modern-scientific parallels. Your child will learn to (a) name and use precise Sanskrit terms, (b) understand the observational basis for the classical framework, and (c) relate it to current scientific or scholarly understanding.

What you can do at home

This module connects classical ecological wisdom with the current climate crisis. Talk with your child about local environmental concerns — water, waste, trees in your area — and how your family already practices small acts of conservation.

Conversation prompts

Try one of these over a meal or walk:

1. “What’s one Sanskrit word you learned this week? What does it mean?”
2. “What did you find surprising in this module?”
3. “Is there anything you’re not sure about? Let’s look it up together.”
4. “How would you explain this to your grandmother / grandfather?”

Questions parents often ask

Q: Is this religious instruction? A: No. The module presents Indian classical frameworks (cosmology, mathematics, astronomy, ecology) as historical knowledge systems with their own logic and method. The framing is scholarly and comparative, not devotional.

Q: Will my child be tested on Sanskrit? A: Sanskrit terms are introduced for precision, not for rote memorisation. The summative quiz asks students to *use* the terms — for example, “Which doṣa is dominant in the morning hours?” — rather than translate them.

Q: How does this connect to NCERT / board syllabus? A: This module supplements (does not replace) NCERT content. NEP 2020 §4.6 calls for the integration of Indian Knowledge Systems. The pack’s README.md lists the specific NEP principles each module advances.

Reading further (for parents)

See sources.md in this pack for the full source list.

10-Day Lesson Plan

Lesson Plan — Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary)

10-day arc, 30 min per session.

Day 1 — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam

Objective: Identify the source verse and explain the principle.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 2 — Five Elements as Ecological Frame

Objective: Link Module 2 pañcabhūta to ecology — interconnection.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 3 — Rivers as Sacred

Objective: Discuss the ecological function of river-worship traditions.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 4 — Sacred Groves

Objective: Identify devarakāṇḍu and similar groves as biodiversity reserves.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 5 — Yajña — The Ecological Cycle

Objective: Read BG 3.10–14; map yajña to natural-cycle reciprocity.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 6 — Pṛthivī Sūkta (AV 12.1)

Objective: Read the Earth-mother hymn and discuss imagery.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 7 — Iṣopaniṣad — Non-Greed Ethic

Objective: Translate *īśāvāsyam idaṁ sarvaṁ* and discuss its ecological implication.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 8 — Climate Change — The Crisis

Objective: Summarise key IPCC findings; what is changing and why.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 9 — From Ancient to Action

Objective: Design one local environmental project applying an Indic-ecology principle.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 10 — Project Pitch and Assessment

Objective: Present project pitches; summative quiz.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Pacing notes

- Primary sessions are 30 min. Adjust if your block is different.
- Days 5 and 9 are buffer days — use to reinforce weaker concepts or extend stronger ones.
- The summative project (see [assessments/project-brief.md](#)) runs in parallel from Day 6 onward.

Differentiation

- **For advanced students:** see [teacher-notes.md](#) for extension prompts.
- **For students needing more support:** simplify activities, do more pair-work, allow oral instead of written responses.

Homework

Homework — Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary)

Light daily tasks. Each takes 5–10 minutes.

1. **Day 1 — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
2. **Day 2 — Five Elements as Ecological Frame** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
3. **Day 3 — Rivers as Sacred** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
4. **Day 4 — Sacred Groves** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
5. **Day 5 — Yajña — The Ecological Cycle** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
6. **Day 6 — Pṛthivī Sūkta (AV 12.1)** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
7. **Day 7 — Iṣopaniṣad — Non-Greed Ethic** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
8. **Day 8 — Climate Change — The Crisis** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
9. **Day 9 — From Ancient to Action** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
10. **Day 10 — Project Pitch and Assessment** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)

Notes

- Homework is intended to consolidate what was learned in class, not introduce new content.
- If a child struggles, the parent should consult the teacher rather than push.
- Capstone project days (Module 15) may have lighter daily homework so students can focus on the project.